

In Canada

In Canada, all levels of government—municipal, federal, and provincial—issue government bonds. In addition to municipal, federal, and provincial bonds, corporate bonds are also available for purchase.³ A great resource to learn more about the different types of Canadian bonds, how they work, and where to buy them is on the website [GetSmarterAboutMoney.ca](https://www.getsmarteraboutmoney.ca/invest/investment-products/bonds/) (<https://www.getsmarteraboutmoney.ca/invest/investment-products/bonds/>).

Outside the U.S. or Canada

You can learn more about bonds offered in your country from a local bank or brokerage or by speaking with a licensed financial advisor in your location.

SHOULD YOU BUY INDIVIDUAL STOCKS AND/OR BONDS?

Now that you have some insight into stocks and bonds as investment types, you should know that you don't have to buy them one by one. You also have the option of effectively buying many stocks or bonds at once by investing in funds.

As we'll go over next, funds provide a simpler way to make sure your money is well-diversified. Buying individual stocks and bonds is often more risky due to less diversification, unless you're individually buying hundreds of different stocks across different company types and industries (which is more labor-intensive and expensive if your brokerage charges a fee per purchase).

If you are new to investing or prefer an easier, more hands-off approach, then investing with built-in variety and diversification is the way to go and starting out with funds is a great idea.